



LEVEL 2

Your survey report

Property address

55 Avon Street Warwick CV34 4PX

Clients name

Mr O M Yerbury-Hodgson & Miss C Chousmer-Kerr

Inspection date

08 January 2024

Surveyor's RICS number

0101329

2

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A

About the inspection and report

This RICS Home Survey – Level 2 has been produced by a surveyor, who has written this report for you to use. If you decide not to act on the advice in this report, you do so at your own risk.

About the inspection and report

As agreed, this report will contain the following:

- a physical inspection of the property (see *The inspection* in section L) and
- a report based on the inspection (see *The inspection* in section L).

About the report

We aim to give you professional advice to:

- make a reasoned and informed decision on whether to go ahead with buying the property
- make an informed decision on what is a reasonable price to pay for the property
- take into account any significant repairs or replacements the property needs, and
- consider what further advice you should take before committing to purchasing the property.

Any extra services we provide that are not covered by the terms and conditions of this report must be covered by a separate contract.

About the inspection

- We only carry out a visual inspection. Also, we do not remove secured panels or undo electrical fittings.
- We inspect roofs, chimneys and other surfaces on the outside of the building from ground level and, if necessary, from neighbouring public property and with the help of binoculars.
- We inspect the roof structure from inside the roof space if there is access (although we do not move or lift insulation material, stored goods or other contents). We examine floor surfaces and under-floor spaces so far as there is safe access to these (although we do not move or lift furniture, floor coverings or other contents). We do not remove the contents of cupboards. We are not able to assess the condition of the inside of any chimney, boiler or other flues. Also, we do not remove secured panels or undo electrical fittings.
- We note in our report if we are not able to check any parts of the property that the inspection would normally cover. If we are concerned about these parts, the report will tell you about any further investigations that are needed.
- We do not report on the cost of any work to put right defects or make recommendations on how these repairs should be carried out. Some maintenance and repairs we suggest may be expensive.
- We inspect the inside and outside of the main building and all permanent outbuildings, but we do not force or open up the fabric of the building. We also inspect the parts of the electricity, gas/oil, water, heating and drainage services that can be seen, but we do not test them.
- To help describe the condition of the home, we give condition ratings to the main parts (the 'elements') of the building, garage and some parts outside. Some elements can be made up of several different parts.
- In the element boxes in sections D, E, F and G, we describe the part that has the worst condition rating first and then briefly outline the condition of the other parts. The condition ratings are described in section B of this report. The report covers matters that, in the surveyor's opinion, need to be dealt with or may affect the value of the property.

! Reminder

Please refer to your **Terms and Conditions**, that were sent to you at the point you (Mr O M Yerbury-Hodgson & Miss C Chousmer-Kerr) confirmed your instruction to us (), for a full list of exclusions.

About the inspection and report

Surveyor's name

G A Wingrove

Surveyor's RICS number

0101329

Company name

Countrywide Surveyors

Date of the inspection

08 January 2024

Report reference number

CW-170609

Related party disclosure

I am not aware of any conflicts of interest.

Full address and postcode of the property

55 Avon Street Warwick CV34 4PX

Weather conditions when the inspection took place

It was dry when I inspected the property. Prior to my inspection the weather was changeable.

Status of the property when the inspection took place

When I inspected the property it was occupied and furnished. There were floor coverings only to the hallway and kitchen.

B

Overall opinion

This section provides our overall opinion of the property, highlights any areas of concern and summarises the condition ratings of the different elements of the property. Individual elements of the property have been rated to indicate any defects, and have been grouped by the urgency of any required maintenance.

If an element is made up of a number of different parts (for example, a pitched roof to the main building and a flat roof to an extension), only the part in the worst condition is shown here.

Important note

To get a balanced impression of the property, we strongly recommend that you read all sections of the report, in particular section K, What to do now, and discuss this with us if required.

Summary of condition ratings

Overall opinion of property

I regret to advise that I am unable to provide a valuation until all the further investigations I have recommended have been concluded and I have had the opportunity to consider the findings along with the cost and extent of any works.

Where elements have a Condition Rating of 2 and 3, I draw your attention to the explanation of these terms in Section B and to the advice given in the 'What to do now' section. You should ensure that you have undertaken any recommended further investigations and are fully aware of the financial obligations for any repairs needed before you commit to purchase this property.

For support with further investigations you may wish to contact Specialist Xpress on 01367 240077 or alternatively you can visit their website at <https://specialistxpress.com>. Other service providers are available.

The property has been altered. There is nothing to suggest that the works have not been completed to a satisfactory standard. Your Legal Adviser(s) should ensure that all relevant statutory approvals have been obtained.

Working at height can be expensive and present a number of difficulties which can increase cost. Not only may scaffolding be required, but obstructions like conservatories or extensions can necessitate more complicated access arrangements.

Overall opinion

To determine the condition of the property, we assess the main parts (the 'elements') of the building, garage and some outside areas. These elements are rated on the urgency of maintenance needed, ranging from 'very urgent' to 'no issues recorded'.

3

Elements that require urgent attention

These elements have defects that are serious and/or need to be repaired, replaced or investigated urgently. Failure to do so could risk serious safety issues or severe long-term damage to your property.

Element no.	Element name
D1	Chimney stacks
D2	Roof coverings
D4	Main walls
E1	Roof structure
E3	Walls and partitions
E4	Floors
E5	Fireplaces, chimney breasts and flues
E7	Woodwork
E9	Other
F1	Electricity
F2	Gas/oil
F4	Heating
F5	Water heating

2

Elements that require attention but are not serious or urgent

These elements have defects that need repairing or replacing, but are not considered to be either serious or urgent. These elements must also be maintained in the normal way.

Element no.	Element name
D5	Windows
E2	Ceilings
E6	Built-in fittings

Overall opinion (continued)

2

Elements that require attention but are not serious or urgent (continued)

These elements have defects that need repairing or replacing, but are not considered to be either serious or urgent. These elements must also be maintained in the normal way.

Element no.	Element name
F6	Drainage
G3	Other

1

Elements with no current issues

No repair is currently needed. The elements listed here must be maintained in the normal way.

Element no.	Element name
D3	Rainwater pipes and gutters
D6	Outside doors
D8	Other joinery and finishes
E8	Bathroom fittings
F3	Water

NI

Elements not inspected

We carry out a visual inspection, so a number of elements may not have been inspected. These are listed here.

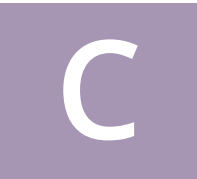
Element no.	Element name
-------------	--------------

C

About the property

This section includes:

- About the property
- Energy efficiency
- Location and facilities



About the property

Type of property

This is a mid-terraced house. The front of the property faces approximately south-west. Any references to the left or right of the property are given as if viewing the building from the front.

I have not been able to obtain any information about the property from the owner.

Approximate year the property was built

1900

Approximate year the property was extended

N/A

Approximate year the property was converted

N/A

Information relevant to flats and maisonettes

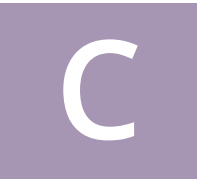
No additional comments are required in this section of the report.

Construction

The property is of traditional construction with brick walls, under a sloping roof. The floors are of solid concrete and suspended timber construction.

Accommodation

Living rooms	Bedrooms	Bath or Shower	Separate Toilet	Kitchen	Utility Room	Conservatory	Other
1	2	1		1			1



Energy efficiency rating

We have not prepared the Energy Performance Certificate (EPC). If we have seen the EPC, we will present the ratings here.

We have checked for any obvious discrepancies between the EPC and the subject property.

We are advised that the property’s current energy performance, as recorded in the EPC, is:

Energy efficiency rating

D58

Issues relating to the energy efficiency rating

The property attributes stated within the EPC are not consistent with the findings of my inspection. The following discrepancies were noted;

The comments about floor and loft insulation stated within the EPC are not as described. This could mean that the EPC rating provided is no longer accurate.

Mains services

A marked box shows that the relevant mains service is present.

☒ Gas

☒ Electric

☒ Water

☒ Drainage

Central heating

☒ Gas

☐ Electric

☐ Solid Fuel

☐ Oil

☐ None

Other services or energy sources (including feed-in tariffs)

There are no other services or energy sources.

Other energy matters

I found no issues relating to other energy matters.

Location and facilities

Grounds

There are gardens to the front and rear. The property does not have a garage and there is no private parking with the property. Roadside parking is available. However, available space is very limited and it may be difficult to find a space at peak times.

There are no permanent outbuildings with the property.

Location

The property is located in a suburban area. The surrounding properties are mainly residential.

Facilities

The property is close to a range of local schools, including nursery, primary and secondary. There is access to good transport links. It is conveniently located with a good range of amenities nearby.

Local environment

I know of no adverse environmental factors affecting the property or its immediate surroundings.

D

Outside the property

Outside the property

Limitations to the inspection

I could not fully inspect the chimneys because of the height and configuration of the roof and the limited reach of a surveyor's ladder.

I could not fully inspect the main roof to the rear two storey outrigger because of the height and configuration of the roof, the size and layout of the plot and the limited reach of a surveyor's ladder.

As it was not raining whilst I inspected the property, I am unable to confirm that the rainwater fittings are watertight and discharging correctly.

Some windows were out of reach of the standard surveyors ladder and could not be fully inspected.

The rear french doors were locked with no keys available.

I could not fully inspect the external joinery to the property because of the height and configuration of the roof, the rainwater fittings and the limited reach of a standard surveyor's ladder.

D1 Chimney stacks

1 2 3 NI

The property has three chimney stacks built in brick. The left hand chimneys are built in brick and the rear chimney is rendered. The stacks are all shared with the adjoining property. The front and rear stacks have clay pots and these flues are unused and have not been capped. The rear chimney has been capped but does not appear to have been vented. The flashings around the left hand stacks appear to be lead. There are aërials attached to the chimneys.

The mortar pointing to the left hand stacks is weathered. Some repointing is required to reduce further deterioration and structural problems arising.

Some bricks are weathered and spalled. All affected masonry should be cut out and replaced to reduce further deterioration, damp penetration and structural problems arising.

The render to the rear stack is badly cracked, loose and weathered and requires substantial repair or replacement. This may require the affected render to be removed, any underlying issues to the masonry below will need to be repaired and the area should be re-rendered.

The flue terminal to the rear stack appears capped and now redundant. No visible air brick or ventilation was seen at the head of the stack, in order to ventilate the redundant flue voids. The chimney breasts below have been removed, but the flue should be ventilated and checks should also be made for adequate capping at the same time.

If the flues are not to be used, then you should have them capped off and ventilated.

The flashing to the chimneys is defective and should be replaced. This has resulted in water ingress and dampness internally and repairs should be undertaken as a matter of urgency to prevent further damage.

This work should be carried out as a matter of urgency to prevent the risk of damage to other elements.

Outside the property (continued)

D1 Chimney stacks (continued)

1 2 3 NI

The entirety of the chimneys could not be seen and there may be hidden defects. Unless fully inspected there is a risk of potentially costly repairs. The condition rating assigned is based on what was visible at to me at the time of my inspection.

Chimneys in a property of this age are unlikely to contain a damp-proof course and there is a risk of rain penetration. To reduce this risk the chimney stacks must be well maintained.

Considering the age of the property it is not uncommon for the bedding mortar around the pots to have become loose and cracked and a closer inspection could reveal that it needs repair or replacement. This should be checked when access is next made to the roof or chimney for normal maintenance.

The owner of the neighbouring property will have rights (and responsibilities) with regard to the shared stacks and you should check with your Legal Adviser before any work is undertaken.

Health and Safety requirements and other difficulties associated with working at height makes repairs to chimneys relatively expensive.



Outside the property (continued)



Chimneys

D2 Roof coverings

The roofs are covered with concrete tiles. The ridge is tiled. The front bay window has a pitched roof covered in tiles.

3

The roof coverings to the main roof have been replaced and your Legal Adviser should check that works were completed in accordance with any Local Authority requirements.

The flashings to the front bay roofs are metal. Metal flashings are most commonly lead but may also be zinc. The flaunchings to the front bay are formed with mortar.

There is some sagging to the main roof slopes. I would recommend improving support to the roof structure to reduce the risk of any issues arising in the future. Any assessment of the roof structure and repairs should only be specified by a Chartered Structural Engineer. Such work could be costly and it would be prudent to obtain quotations before exchange of contracts.

There is moss growing on the surface of the roofs reducing water run off which in turn will affect performance of the coverings. It should be carefully removed where build up is occurring.

There is evidence of water penetration adjacent to the chimney flues within the main roof space and immediate attention is required to limit the risk of damage to other elements. I recommend you instruct a reputable roofing contractor to inspect and advise you on the suitability of the current arrangement and options for improvement. It is likely that any work required will be relatively expensive and disruptive. There may be associated damage to the supporting timbers and you should ensure these are checked and repaired or replaced as necessary.

Outside the property (continued)

D2 Roof coverings (continued)

3

Bedding mortar to the rear roof verge is defective and needs repairs. You may wish to introduce dry verge caps which remove the need for pointing.

The verges have been formed without proprietary clips to hold the edge tiles in place. This makes the roof covering more vulnerable to wind damage than when clips are installed. It appears, however, to have performed adequately to date and there is no evidence of recent repairs to the roof coverings. As the property is not in an overly exposed location remedial work does not seem currently justified. Alternatively, you may wish to introduce dry verge caps. When installed correctly, these caps remove the need for both verge clips and pointing.

The rear outrigger roof is not visible. Whilst there is no evidence of any previous or current leaks, based on the age and overall condition of the property there may be hidden defects. Unless fully inspected there is a risk of potentially costly repairs and I recommend that you arrange for a more detailed inspection to be undertaken before purchase.

I was unable to inspect the entirety of the main roof and there may be hidden defects. Unless fully inspected there is a risk of potentially costly repairs. The condition rating assigned is based on what was visible at to me at the time of my inspection.

The eaves felt (located at the lowest part of the roof) should overlap into the guttering. This perishes with age and exposure to sunlight which can lead to roof leaks and decay to adjacent timbers. It should be checked as part of normal maintenance.

Metal flashings are most commonly lead but may also be zinc. Both metals are grey in colour. When viewed from the ground it is often difficult or impossible to tell whether the metal flashings have been formed in lead, zinc, or a combination of these metals.

The flaunching is a fillet of mortar traditionally used to protect the joint between the roof and the wall from water penetration. Mortar is a brittle material and can crack with time, particularly in exposed locations and it can leak without warning.

You should check your roof at least once per year. During this annual maintenance check you should note any build-up of dirt, moss, algae or lichen. Where moss, algae or lichen growth is visible, you should arrange to have the roof cleaned in order to prevent this worsening over time. This ensures water can freely flow from the roof slopes preventing any associated damage to the roof coverings due to retained moisture.

A simple, effective way to clean roof tiles is to carefully scrape off the moss, algae, lichen and dirt by hand using a tool such as a trowel. This is best accomplished during dry weather as the moss and other materials will not be stuck to the tiles with moisture. Alternatively, similar results can be achieved with a stiff brush.

There is a recently growing trend of cleaning roof tiles with a pressure washer. This can do more harm than good because the high pressure water jet can remove the finish of the roof tiles along with any moss, algae, lichen and dirt, and removing the tile surface can reduce their lifespan. There is also an additional risk of penetrating dampness as, under pressure, the water will enter any small cracks or gaps in the tiles or be blown under them, potentially resulting in damage to other parts of the building.

Outside the property (continued)

D3 Rainwater pipes and gutters

The rainwater gutters are plastic and the downpipes are plastic. The rear downpipe incorporates a plastic hopper head. The front downpipe goes into the ground and is assumed to be connected to a suitable discharge point such as a drain or soak away but this cannot be verified without further investigations.

1

The rear downpipe discharges into a gulley. The gulley is assumed to be connected to a suitable discharge point such as a drain or soak away but this cannot be verified without further investigations. Rainwater from the neighbouring properties roof discharges into the downpipe on the front of the property.

The rainwater fittings are satisfactory.

Allowing leaves, moss, and other debris to accumulate and create blockages is one of the most frequent causes of gutter-related dampness problems. The weight of the accumulated material can cause gutters to leak at joints or even to collapse completely. However, all of this may be prevented by cleaning gutters frequently, preferably twice a year.

Plastic rainwater fittings are relatively low maintenance although the joints are sealed with flexible gaskets and these perish with age, commonly lasting around 20 years.

Hopper heads are a traditional and functional component. They are used to increase water flow when there is heavy rainfall, allowing the downpipes to reach full capacity and therefore enabling the management of higher volumes of water.

D4 Main walls

The main walls are of solid construction with a brick finish. There is a slate damp-proof course to the walls. In addition, a remedial chemical injection damp proof course has been installed to the main building. The raised parapets to the party walls are built in brick and are capped with concrete copings.

3

There is minor cracking and distortion to the main building. I believe the cause of the movement to be due to old settlement within the structure. On the basis of a single visual inspection the movement appears to be longstanding and not progressive. Further significant movement is unlikely to occur. You may wish to have the cracks carefully repaired as a cosmetic improvement although this is not essential. Movement of this type can be seasonal and it is possible that the cracks may reappear in time.

Some bricks have lost their face this is known as 'Spalling'. Localised repairs are needed. Spalling bricks can either be replaced or repaired using a slim brick face, known as 'brick slip', which is added to the front of the damaged brick to cover any damage.

The mortar pointing to the walls is partially missing and weathered and localised repointing is required.

The coping stones on top of the parapets appear in fair order from ground level but as they are very exposed, copings are vulnerable to decay and dislodging. Therefore, for safety reasons a closer inspection should be made to check the quality of the copings when access is gained to the roof for repairs or maintenance.

Outside the property (continued)

D4 Main walls (continued)

The front bay window sill is cracked and weathered and the front door ornate lintel is also weathered and needs repair and maintenance to reduce the risk of dampness.

3

If repairs are not carried out within a reasonable time the defect could become worse and there is a risk of further damage to the walls.

Solid walls rely on their thickness to prevent penetrating damp. The principle being that the outer surface of the wall will soak up moisture during periods of wet weather which then evaporates off naturally during dry weather, before it penetrates the full thickness of the wall. When repairing the walls it is important that the correct strength of mortar pointing or render is used. Repairing with a mix that is too strong inhibits this evaporation process, increasing the risk of internal damp and external frost damage to the masonry.

Given the age of the property the foundations to the rear outrigger may not be as deep as in a modern building and this increases the risk of structural movement. No signs of structural movement due to foundation problems were seen. The risk of structural movement occurring in the future can be minimised by keeping large trees and shrubs well away from the building and pruned back, and by properly maintaining the drainage system to minimise leakage, both above and below ground.

The masonry over the majority of openings appears to be supported by the window and door frames rather than by a lintel. Some minor cracking and distortion was noted but no repairs are required. When the windows and doors are replaced additional support will need to be provided.

The walls have been structurally altered by the introduction of new windows and doors. Your Legal Adviser should confirm that local authority approval was sought and granted.

Buildings move and distort over their lifetime. This is because the weight of a building is not evenly distributed through all parts of the walls or structure. Some parts are more heavily loaded than others and this compresses them over years or decades, often resulting in parts of a building being out of square. This can be often most noticeable at door openings. This is perfectly normal and provided that the amount of movement is within acceptable structural limits then no remedial action is required other than for cosmetic reasons.

When a property has been diagnosed as suffering from rising dampness it is common practice to insert a new chemical injection damp proof course into the walls. Historically this was a very uncontrolled industry and the effectiveness of such treatment is often questionable. In our experience replacement silicone injection damp proof course work is unreliable.

D5 Windows

The window frames are of plastic (uPVC) construction. They are double glazed. The windows have been replaced at some point in the past.

2

The window frame above the front door is of softwood timber construction and is single glazed.

None of the windows have trickle vents.

In a small number of panes the glazing has misted over due to failure of the seals. This cannot be repaired. The affected panes need re-glazing.

Outside the property (continued)

D5 Windows (continued)

Some of the window furniture is loose and needs attention as part of normal maintenance.

2

Checks were made for internal damp ingress to the window sills and frame reveals and no damp was found.

The frames are in satisfactory condition and no repairs are needed.

Since April 2002 replacement windows should either have Building Regulation approval or a FENSA certificate. I refer you to my comment in Section H.

The repair and on-going redecoration of timber window frames is a labour intensive process and is relatively expensive. Many people choose to replace older windows rather than repair them. Replacing windows is controlled by Building Regulations and may also require planning consent in some cases. The final decision is one for you to make.

It is essential that the seals between the window frames and the walls are regularly checked and kept in good condition.

Over time the factory formed seals between the double glazed window panes may fail causing misting within the glazing. You should check whether there are any guarantees available.

Trickle vents are required by Building Regulations when replacing windows that already have trickle vents fitted. For new window frames that are replacing old windows without vents, it must be demonstrated that ventilation will not be made worse by the installation of the new energy-efficient window.

Trickle vents can be manually opened or closed. However, they are there to provide a constant background feed of air to reduce moisture and improve air quality and therefore they should normally be left open.

D6 Outside doors (including patio doors)

The front door is of timber construction. The rear French doors are of softwood construction. The French door is fully glazed. The front door is part glazed. They are double glazed to various thicknesses.

1

The doors are satisfactory and no repairs are needed.

Over time the factory formed seals between the double glazed panes may fail causing misting within the glazing. You should check whether there are any guarantees available. Since April 2002 replacement doors should either have Building Regulation approval or a FENSA certificate.

Repair and redecoration of these types of doors and frames is a labour intensive and expensive process. Many people choose to replace old doors rather than repair them. Replacing doors is controlled by Building Regulations and may also require planning consent in some cases. The final decision is one for the purchaser.

It is essential that the seals between the door frames and the walls are regularly checked and kept in good condition.

The doors will have poor performance in terms of heat loss and will be draughty. You should consider alternative methods of improving the thermal performance of the doors, such as the installation of draught proofing.

Outside the property (continued)

D7 Conservatory and porches

None

D8 Other joinery and finishes

The fascia, soffits and trim are formed in uPVC.

The external joinery is in satisfactory condition.

There is no visible ventilation to the eaves and improvements may be required.

Original joinery elements may have been covered by newer materials and there is therefore a risk of hidden defects, including decay. This can only be determined by exposing the original elements.

1

D9 Other

None

E

Inside the property

Inside the property

Limitations to inspection

There is no access hatch to the rear outrigger roof space. No inspection was possible.

My inspection of the main roof space was severely restricted by the presence of insulation material, stored items and loft boards.

The ceilings were partly hidden by heavily textured paper.

The walls were partly hidden by ceramic tiles and shelving and furniture, heavy paper lining, fitted cupboards, stored items and hanging pictures.

My inspection for damp was restricted by fitted cupboards, ceramic tiles and furniture.

The tiles and other floor coverings restricted my inspection of the floor structures.

The fireplaces in the bedrooms have been covered over.

Stored items within the kitchen fitted units restricted my inspection.

I have not carried out any testing on the built in appliances. You should have these checked by a specialist if they are important to your purchase.

The stair underlining limited my assessment of the staircase.

My inspection of the bathroom fittings was restricted due to tiled finishes and fitted unit.

I could not fully inspect the cellar because of stored items and personal belongings and appliances.

E1 Roof structure

1 2 3 NI

The main roof is made up with timber rafters and purlins (horizontal beams). The roof is lined with felt and is insulated between ceiling joists, although this is limited to some areas.

3

The main roof and rear outrigger roof coverings have been replaced with tiles which will be heavier than the original covering. The main roof structure has not been upgraded to compensate for the additional loads. The structure is sagging, split timbers and is overloaded. The roof structure needs to be improved. You should take more detailed professional advice from a suitably competent person such as a Chartered Structural Engineer. Repair works could be costly and estimates should be obtained before a commitment to purchase.

Some staining is present to some of the rafters and purlins. This appears to have been caused by a leak and further investigation of the flashings and roof covering is required.

The ventilation within the main roof and outrigger space is inadequate and needs improving. Roof structures require ventilation in order to ensure any moisture and condensation is taken into the atmosphere. Excess condensation can cause timber defects such as rot and beetle infestation.

Inside the property (continued)

E1 Roof structure (continued)

1 2 3 NI

Leakage is occurring past the chimney flashings to the right hand side. Repairs are needed and nearby timbers checked for decay.

3

There is evidence of possible condensation within the roof space caused by the lack of adequate ventilation to the roof space coupled with inadequate levels of insulation. Improvements are urgently required. If this is not rectified as a matter of urgency it could cause more serious defects to develop.

The right hand party wall to the main roof is incomplete. The gaps should be sealed.

The level of insulation is below modern standards and should be improved. You should arrange to have an adequate depth of insulation installed, currently the recommendation is to install not less than 270mm, however you should obtain advice of the installer as different types and makes of insulation have differing insulation properties.



Roof structure

Inside the property (continued)



Roof structure

Inside the property (continued)



Roof structure

Inside the property (continued)



Roof structure

E2 Ceilings

The ceilings are formed with lath and plaster and plasterboard. The ceilings have painted finishes. Some of the ceilings have papered finishes. These linings may well conceal cracks to the plaster finishes.

2

There are non structural shrinkage cracks at the plasterboard joints. These can be filled during the next normal redecoration cycle, but such cracks do tend to reoccur seasonally.

Some ceilings are bowing but they are functional and no repairs are considered necessary.

Some lath and plaster ceilings have loosened to some degree (plaster de-bonding from laths). This is not severe at present but is a slow, gradual process and is likely to get worse with time. You should allow for on-going repair but ultimately renewal will be required.

Original lath and plaster ceilings are constructed with thin timber strips (laths) nailed to the underside of timber joists with a gap between each strip. Plaster is then applied to the laths and pushed up between them to stick the plaster into place. With time the plaster loosens, cracks and will eventually collapse. The original lath and plaster ceilings will also be susceptible to damage from vibration and any disturbance and they can fail without warning. You should allow for on-going repair but ultimately renewal will be required.

Plasterboard ceilings will often crack along the joints of the plasterboard. This is not serious but if the cracks are filled they are likely to recur seasonally.

Inside the property (continued)

E2 Ceilings (continued)

Should you wish to preserve the original features, the decorative cornice will need careful restoration which will increase the cost of any repairs. Such work should only be entrusted to experienced craftsmen.

2

Some ceilings have heavy paper finishes. These are notoriously difficult to remove without causing damage to the plaster beneath and were often used to mask defects. If you intend to remove these finishes when redecorating you should budget for some plaster repairs. Alternatively, you may wish to consider plasterboarding over the existing finishes which may save time and money.

E3 Walls and partitions

The walls are a combination of solid masonry construction and stud partition. They have a combination of plasterboard and plaster finishes. There are ceramic tiled finishes to the bathroom. They have mostly painted and papered finishes.

3

Localised high damp meter readings were recorded to the ground floor walls in the hallway, rear reception wall and middle reception wall and continuing dampness is inevitable unless proper damp-proofing is carried out. A decision therefore has to be made as to whether to live with the dampness in this location, or to have repair works undertaken.

There is a risk of concealed decay to the wall timbers because of the damp found and further investigations should be undertaken by a member of the Property Care Association or similar.

I also recorded high damp meter readings to the basement/cellar, where the evidence suggests damp is penetrating through the wall as a result of possible high water table, defective rainwater fittings and drainage and poor ventilation and humidity. Repairs and improvements are required. There is restricted natural ventilation to the basement due to the covering of the vent to the front bay and installation of a double glazed unit within the basement.

There is a risk of associated decay in adjacent timbers and further investigation by a member of the Property Care Association or similar is required.

There are minor cracks in the walls, such cracks are very common and are not of structural importance. They should be filled when the rooms are next redecorated.

Sections of plaster throughout the property are cracked and loose and repairs are required.

There is some distortion evident particularly around openings. This is very common and is not of concern. There is no need for any structural repairs but you may find it necessary to adjust the doors from time to time.

The wall between the front and rear reception has been removed. Your Legal Adviser should confirm that Building Regulation approval was granted. If there is no evidence of approval then you will need to arrange for further investigation by a Chartered Structural Engineer or Chartered Building Surveyor.

Removal of vendors fittings and other items from walls may necessitate some minor cosmetic filling and making good of plaster finishes in places.

With time plaster can often loosen from the wall to which it is applied. The degree to which this occurs depends on several factors such as orientation, humidity and the quality of the plaster.

Inside the property (continued)

E3 Walls and partitions (continued)

The old plaster finishes are very prone to vibration and disturbance, such as that experienced when doors slam or when new services or joinery timbers are installed. The plaster could be loose in places and on-going patch repairs will be necessary from time-to-time.

Plasterboard finishes often crack along the joints between the boards. This is not serious but if the cracks are filled they are likely to recur seasonally.

Some walls have heavy paper finishes which may conceal defects. Repairs/improvements may be needed if the coverings are removed.

The presence and extent of condensation in a dwelling will depend not only on its orientation and construction, but on variable factors such as weather conditions, lifestyle, and how the property is heated and ventilated. Adequate heating and ventilation will help to keep condensation to a minimum. I would also refer you to my additional comments in Section I3 of this report.

3



Walls (interior)

E4 Floors

The ground floor kitchen area is of solid construction. Elsewhere the floors are of suspended timber construction. The basement is of solid construction. Sub floor ventilation is provided by a vent to the front of the bay window structure.

3

Inside the property (continued)

E4 Floors (continued)

3

As mentioned in Section E3 damp was found and sub floor ventilation is restricted. There is a risk of decay beneath the floor and further investigation is recommended by a suitably competent person such as a member of the Property Care Association or similar. Further investigation may involve raising floor boards and you will need the vendor's permission for this. Repair works could be costly and estimates should be obtained before a commitment to purchase.

There is evidence of flight holes from wood boring beetles, commonly referred to as "Woodworm" in the floor timbers. The appearance of the flight holes would however suggest that this is old and there is no evidence of fresh activity.

Damage that is often referred to as "Woodworm" is caused by the larvae (maggots) of wood boring beetles. Just as a caterpillar is the larval stage of a butterfly, the "woodworm" is the larval stage of the adult beetle. When the woodworm changes into a beetle it leaves the timber creating the characteristic woodworm flight hole.

Sections of the floor boards are damaged and these need repair or replacement. Some further damage to floor boards might be revealed when floor coverings are removed.

Some floors creak underfoot. This does not appear to be due to a serious problem but you may find this unsatisfactory and wish to undertake repair work to reduce this problem.

The bedroom floors are creaking excessively. It is very difficult or impossible to prevent this without re-fixing all the boards. Whilst creaking can be a nuisance, most people choose to tolerate this rather than commit to the expense of undertaking the repairs.

Timbers within older floors are likely to be undersized by modern standards and some minor springing has occurred. This is common and no improvements are considered necessary.

Suspended timber floors near the ground must be ventilated to help limit the moisture content of the floor timbers. If the moisture content is too high it increases the risks of serious wood rot and of infestation by wood boring beetles. The support to the joists may also be bedded onto walls with no damp proofing present which also increases the risk of decay. As part of your annual maintenance routine, you should inspect each sub floor vent, ensuring it is free from damage and clear from any debris or obstruction.

What is commonly referred to as rot in timber is caused by several species of fungus. These are often divided into two categories, dry rot and wet rot. On the basis of a visual inspection it is often difficult or impossible to conclusively determine whether a fungal attack is wet rot or dry rot. Unless the fungus has become well advanced, the symptoms are visibly very similar. Conditions can exist for both types of fungal decay (rot) to occur together.

Dry rot is a misnomer as all types of wood rotting fungus require dampness in order to live. Dry rot does not however need such damp conditions as wet rot. Dry rot prefers dark conditions and because of this it can develop to quite an advanced stage under floors or behind panelling, before it becomes visibly apparent. Poorly ventilated and damp timbers are particularly at risk, for example badly ventilated suspended timber ground floors. Dry rot is relatively rare but if it does occur it can cause extensive and widespread damage.

Solid ground floors are often described as "ground bearing". This means that they are built on a compacted base which is in turn bearing on the ground below.

Inside the property (continued)



Floors

Inside the property (continued)



Floors

E5 Fireplaces, chimney breasts and flues

There are open fires in the living rooms.

High damp meter readings along with damp staining were noted to the chimney breast in the roof space. I believe this may be due to a combination of rainwater running down the flue and acidic flue deposits leaching through the masonry. Further investigation is needed by member of the Property Care Association (or similar).

There is no ventilation to the redundant flues in the bedrooms and improvements are needed. Redundant flues require ventilation to prevent the build up of condensation within which can lead to the damp staining on the surface of the chimney breast.

If you intend to bring the disused fireplaces back into use, some repair and upgrading may well be required and the flues may need repair or lining which could be costly. If this is your intention, you should seek specialist advice before proceeding.

The internal condition and serviceability of any flue cannot be determined from a visual inspection. Old unlined flues will inevitably deteriorate with age as the acidic products of combustion erode the bricks and mortar joints. As a result they may not be completely smoke and fire tight. For this reason they should be cleaned and smoke tested before use.

Flues should be checked and swept prior to use and this should be done by a reputable chimney sweep.

3

Inside the property (continued)



Fireplaces

Inside the property (continued)



Fireplaces

E6 Built-in fittings (e.g. built-in kitchen and other fittings, not including appliances)

There are fitted units in the kitchen and there is fitted bedroom furniture to the master bedroom and fitted furniture in the rear living room.

2

Some of the kitchen units and sink are showing signs of wear and tear and staining, commensurate with their age and frequent use. I anticipate there will be a desire to replace these fittings and it would be advisable to obtain quotations before you exchange contracts so that you budget accordingly.

The worktop is not properly sealed at its edges. This should be improved to prevent water damage to adjacent surfaces.

E7 Woodwork (e.g. staircase and joinery)

The internal doors are timber panelled. Some doors are partially glazed.

3

Door surrounds and skirtings are of softwood construction.

The staircase leading to the first floor is of timber construction. The staircase leading to the basement is of brick construction.

The glass in the internal bathroom door has no markings to indicate toughened or laminated safety glass is present. To reduce the risk of injury from accidental breakage the glass should be replaced.

Inside the property (continued)

E7 Woodwork (e.g. staircase and joinery) (continued)

The timber staircase creaks underfoot and you may wish to have the treads repaired/refixed.

3

Some doors are in need of adjustment to allow ease of operation.

As mentioned in Section E3 damp was found. Timbers in contact with damp walls are at risk of decay and I would refer you to my earlier advice regarding the need for further investigations by a member of the Property Care Association or similar.

The property is of an age where there could be a lead content in the old paint finishes. I cannot confirm the presence of lead paint as this is outside the scope of this survey. Further advice can be found by visiting <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/advice-on-lead-paint-in-older-homes>.

The doors have been stripped. This stripping agent can damage the glued joints and splits often occur due to moisture changes in the timber.



Woodwork / joinery

E8 Bathroom fittings

There are modern sanitary fittings.

1

No repairs are currently needed.

Inside the property (continued)

E8 Bathroom fittings (continued)

Seals around the sanitary fittings, in particular those around bath/shower cubicles are very prone to leakage. It is important that the seals around the fittings are not allowed to deteriorate and they should be inspected regularly.

1

E9 Other

The cellar is accessed via a staircase from the rear reception room. The area has not been fitted out for habitation and is used as a storage area only.

3

The property has mains powered smoke and carbon monoxide alarms.

The smoke and carbon monoxide alarms appear satisfactory but have not been tested. I refer you to my advice in Section I3 Risks to People.

The cellar steps have no hand rail. Repair or upgrading is needed.

The cellar ceiling is old and is in poor order in places.

The floor is damp. You may wish to consider upgrading.

Ventilation levels in the area are poor. Ventilation should be improved to reduce humidity levels. You should also arrange for further investigation of the concealed timbers by a member of the Property Care Association or similar.

The walls and floor are damp. This is not unusual, although it should be noted that timbers in contact with damp surfaces will be at increased risk of decay. In addition, any stored items within the cellar will be prone to damage. Providing you are willing to accept this risk, then there is no apparent reason to carry out costly damp proofing work at this time.

It is important to ensure the cellar is adequately ventilated at all times. Cellars can be prone to flooding. I saw no evidence of flooding at the time of my inspection but there is always a risk this could occur in the future particularly following heavy rain.

Inside the property (continued)



Other internal

F

Services

Services are generally hidden within the construction of the property. This means that we can only inspect the visible parts of the available services, and we do not carry out specialist tests. The visual inspection cannot assess the services to make sure they work efficiently and safely, and meet modern standards.

Services

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Limitations to inspection

Inspection of the boiler was restricted by partial concealment within a fitted cupboard.

Inspections of below ground drainage were limited to visible areas within the accessible inspection chambers.

F1 Electricity



Safety warning: Electrical Safety First recommends that you should get a registered electrician to check the property and its electrical fittings at least every ten years, or on change of occupancy. All electrical installation work undertaken after 1 January 2005 should have appropriate certification. For more advice, contact Electrical Safety First.

The property is connected to the mains supply.

3

The meter is located in the cellar. The primary consumer unit (fuse box) is also located in the cellar. There is a fixed RCD (Residual Current Device). Where visible, the wiring is in plastic covered cable.

The property appears to have been re-wired. However, much of the wiring is concealed from view and I am unable to confirm the age and condition of the concealed elements of the installation.

Some of the wiring in the roof space has been covered over with insulation which could lead to overheating. In addition, the recessed lights are not protected from insulation and improvements are needed.

I have highlighted some issues with the electrical installation. You should immediately instruct a registered electrician (Registered Competent Person Electrical) to test the installation for safety and carry out any necessary works.

The electrical system has been updated. Your Legal Adviser should check whether the work has Building Regulation approval or has been certified by a registered electrician.

I do not know if there is a current test certificate for the installation. Your legal adviser should establish whether there is a current test certificate. If not then it should be checked before purchase and you should immediately instruct a registered electrician (Registered Competent Person Electrical) to test the installation for safety and carry out any necessary works.

An RCD is a sensitive protective device that, in the event of a fault, turns off power immediately. They are intended to help prevent you from receiving a lethal electric shock if you come in contact with a live object, such as a bare wire. RCDs provide a higher degree of personal protection than traditional fuses and circuit breakers.

It is impossible to fully assess the condition of an electrical installation on the basis of a visual inspection only. There are many factors relating to the adequacy of electrical installations, which can only be identified by a test which covers matters relating to resistance, impedance and current, etc.

Services (continued)



Electricity

F2 Gas/oil

Safety warning: All gas and oil appliances and equipment should regularly be inspected, tested, maintained and serviced by an appropriately qualified Gas Safe Engineer or Registered Heating Engineer and in line with the manufacturer's instructions. For tenanted properties by law a 12 monthly gas safety check must be carried out on every gas appliance/flue. A gas safety check will make sure gas fittings and appliances are safe to use. This is important to make sure that the equipment is working correctly, to limit the risk of fire and carbon monoxide poisoning and to prevent carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases from leaking into the air. For more advice contact the Gas Safe Register for gas installations, and OFTEC for oil installations.

Gas is supplied from the mains. The meter and stop valve are located in the cellar.

3

It has not been possible to confirm that there is a service contract and test certificate for the gas installation.

No serious defects were observed but the installation details and service history is not known. Your legal adviser should check whether there is a current gas safety certificate. In the absence of such documentary evidence being provided then the system should be checked prior to exchange of contracts.

Gas installations should be inspected by a Gas Safe contractor or other suitably competent person on an annual basis.

Services (continued)



Gas / oil

F3 Water

The property has a mains water supply. The external stop tap is located in the pavement. The internal stop tap is located to the top of the staircase to the cellar. The supply pipework is copper where visible. Where visible, the distribution pipework is of copper.

1

The water supply is fed directly from the mains supply with no storage tank. Should the supply be interrupted then you will have no water.

Where visible the plumbing system appears generally satisfactory allowing for age.

If the underground main supply pipe is original, it may be reaching the end of its useful life.

F4 Heating

Central heating is provided by a gas combination condensing boiler located in the airing cupboard in the bathroom.

3

Heating to the rooms is provided by radiators.

Services (continued)

F4 Heating (continued)

The central heating was not running at the time of the inspection and no comment can be made as to its performance or serviceability. I am not aware of any test certificate or service agreement. Your Legal Adviser should be asked to check whether it has been inspected within the last 12 months. In the absence of a formal test certificate you should instruct a Gas Safe registered engineer to test the installation.

3

The area surrounding the boiler should be kept clear to help ventilation and prevent damage.



Heating

F5 Water heating

Hot water is supplied directly from the combination boiler.

The distribution pipes are copper.

The condition of the boiler is described in section F4: HEATING.

Where visible the plumbing system appeared generally satisfactory allowing for its age.

3

Services (continued)

F5 Water heating (continued)

A combination boiler takes cold water directly from the mains and heats it within the boiler before delivering it to the taps. The supply to the taps can only be delivered at the rate at which the boiler can heat it from cold to hot. Consequently the hotter the water required at the fitting, the slower the supply rate will be. Depending on the output of the boiler the supply rate at the taps can be slow.

In hard water areas combination boilers can suffer from a long term build up of lime scale which reduces their efficiency and in the long term shortens the serviceable life of the boiler. It is therefore necessary to have an in line anti scaling device or water softener fitted on the supply pipe serving the boiler.

3

F6 Drainage

I believe the property is connected by a shared drainage system to the public sewer.

Given the age of the property it is likely to have a combined drainage system where the foul and rainwater flow into the same system.

The above ground waste pipes are a plastic.

A macerator is fitted to the cellar.

The above ground drainage pipes appeared satisfactory and no significant remedial work is considered essential at this point in time.

The drain covers were lifted where possible and internally the drains appeared to be clear and free running. All drainage should be inspected and cleaned through periodically.

The inspection chamber cover to the rear is rusting and should be replaced.

The rear gullies are damaged. Repairs and improvements are needed to prevent debris entering the drainage system and causing blockages.

The rainwater pipes do not have any rodding eyes or other means of access to enable the underground drains to be cleared if blockages occur.

The responsibility for many shared underground drainage systems was transferred to local water companies. Your Legal Advisers should make appropriate enquiries.

2

F7 Common services

None

G

Grounds (including shared areas for flats)



Grounds (including shared areas for flats)

Limitations to inspection

My inspection of the boundaries and grounds was limited by the stored items.

G1 Garage

1 2 3 NI

None

G2 Permanent Outbuildings and Other Structures

None

G3 Other

The site boundaries are defined by a combination of brick walls and timber fencing.

The paths are formed with concrete and gravel. There is also a poured concrete apron to the front

The surfaces of the paths are cracked and defective and repair or replacement is needed.

The front gate is missing. Repair or replace.

The front garden terrain does not appear to adequately facilitate proper rainwater drainage. It is advisable to consider landscaping modifications or the installation of drainage systems to mitigate this risk.

The boundary walls will provide limited deterrent to trespass.

2

H

Issues for your legal advisers

We do not act as a legal adviser and will not comment on any legal documents. However, if, during the inspection, we identify issues that your legal advisers may need to investigate further, we may refer to these in the report (for example, to state you should check whether there is a warranty covering replacement windows). You should show your legal advisers this section of the report.

Issues for your legal advisers

H1 Regulation

You should ask your Legal Adviser to confirm that local authority approval was obtained in respect of the following:-

The replacement of the main pitched roofs.

The replacement windows and doors.

The replacement bay window.

The removal of the internal wall.

The altered wall opening to the rear of the property.

The removal of the rear chimney breast(s).

The repair / remedial works to main walls.

The installation of the replacement boiler.

The alterations to the electrical installation.

H2 Guarantees

You should ask your Legal Adviser to make further enquiries to confirm whether the items listed below are covered by a guarantee or warranty that might still be valid and transferrable to a new owner:-

The replacement roof covering(s).

The damp proofing works.

The double glazing.

The replacement boiler.

You should ask your Legal Adviser to make further enquiries to confirm whether the following items have been properly serviced / tested by an appropriate specialist within the last twelve months, and whether certificates are available for the:-

Electrical installation;

Gas installation and appliances;

The heating system;

H3 Other matters

Your Legal Adviser should seek to obtain information relating to the following matters:-

Whether the roads and footpaths are adopted.

Issues for your legal advisers (continued)

H3 Other matters (continued)

Whether the drains are adopted and your rights and responsibilities in respect of the drainage.

The position and ownership of the boundaries.

Whether the owner is aware of any Japanese Knotweed that is or has been on the site.

Works are required that affect the party wall. You may well have rights and obligations under the Party Wall etc. Act 1996 in connection with this.

What are the rights and responsibilities regarding the shared access path.

Whether there is a right to access the neighbouring land to carry out maintenance works.

The property is believed to be Freehold and your Legal Adviser should confirm this and explain the implications.

Risks

This section summarises defects and issues that present a risk to the building or grounds, or a safety risk to people. These may have been reported and condition-rated against more than one part of the property, or may be of a more general nature. They may have existed for some time and cannot be reasonably changed.

Risks

I1 Risks to the building

In properties of this age the timbers are at risk of wood boring beetle (commonly known as woodworm). I found no evidence of this but many timbers were hidden from view and it is possible that infestation is present in those concealed areas.

D1: Chimney stacks: Repairs/Rebuilding needed.

D2: Roof coverings: Structural report required.

D4: Walls: Damp issues.

E1: Roof Structure: Damp issues.

E1: Roof Structure: I found evidence of condensation.

E1: Roof Structure: Wet rot.

E1: Roof structure: Inadequate support.

E3: Walls and Partitions: Risk of timber decay.

E3: Walls and Partitions: Damp issues.

E4: Floors: Evidence of wood boring beetle.

E4: Floors: Risk of timber decay.

E5: Fireplaces, Chimney Breasts and Flues: Damp issues.

E9: Other: Basement/Cellar: Damp issues.

I2 Risks to the grounds

No specific risks were identified.

I3 Risks to people

D1: Chimney: Structural Issues.

D5: Windows: No safety glass.

E1: Roof Structure: Fire resistance compromised due to incomplete party wall(s).

E5: Fireplaces, Chimney Breasts and Flues: Inadequate ventilation.

E7: Woodwork: Unsafe glazing.

E7: Woodwork: Possible lead paint.

Risks (continued)

I3 Risks to people (continued)

F1: Electrics: In the absence of a copy of a recent test certificate being provided a safety check will be required.

F2: Gas/Oil: In the absence of a copy of a recent test certificate being provided a safety check will be required.

F4: Heating: In the absence of a copy of a recent test certificate being provided a safety check will be required.

F5: Water Heating: In the absence of a copy of a recent test certificate being provided a safety check will be required.

Every year the Fire and Rescue Service is called out to approximately 60,000 fires in the home. When you move into your new home you should plan a means of escape for you and your family in case of a fire or other emergency. You should also ensure that smoke alarms are fitted / maintained at each level in the property and that they are regularly tested. (Where battery alarms are used you should check the batteries regularly). It would also be prudent to purchase, fit and maintain a fire extinguisher/blanket in the kitchen.

Condensation is an increasing problem which can be frequently associated with lifestyle issues and care should be taken to avoid activities such as drying clothes indoors. A careful balance of heating, ventilation and insulation should be maintained at all times. It is possible that a property which has not previously suffered with condensation may do so on a change of occupancy.

I4 Other

No comment is required in this section.

J

Surveyor's declaration



Surveyor's declaration

Surveyor's RICS number	Qualifications
0101329	MRICS
Company	
Countrywide Surveyors	
Address	
2 Boundary Court, Willow Farm Business Park, Castle Donington, Derby, DE74 2UD	
Phone number	Fax number
01332 813095	01332813039
Email	
surveysupport@csscustomercare.co.uk	
Website	
www.cwsurveyors.co.uk	
Property address	
55 Avon Street Warwick CV34 4PX	
Client's name	Date this report was produced
Mr O M Yerbury-Hodgson & Miss C Chousmer-Kerr	16 January 2024

I confirm that I have inspected the property and prepared this report

Signature

Electronically Signed By: G A Wingrove

K

What to do now

Further investigations and getting quotes

We have provided advice below on what to do next, now that you have an overview of any work to be carried out on the property. We recommend you make a note of any quotations you receive.

Getting quotations

The cost of repairs may influence the amount you are prepared to pay for the property. Before you make a legal commitment to buy the property, you should get reports and quotations for all the repairs and further investigations the surveyor may have identified. You should get at least two quotations from experienced contractors who are properly insured.

You should also:

- ask them for references from people they have worked for
- describe in writing exactly what you will want them to do and
- get them to put their quotations in writing.

Some repairs will need contractors who have specialist skills and who are members of regulated organisations (for example, electricians, gas engineers, plumbers and so on). You may also need to get Building Regulations permission or planning permission from your local authority for some work.

Further investigations and what they involve

If we are concerned about the condition of a hidden part of the building, could only see part of a defect or do not have the specialist knowledge to assess part of the property fully, we may have recommended that further investigations should be carried out to discover the true extent of the problem.

This will depend on the type of problem, but to do this properly, parts of the home may have to be disturbed, so you should discuss this matter with the current owner. In some cases, the cost of investigation may be high.

When a further investigation is recommended, the following will be included in your report:

- a description of the affected element and why a further investigation is required
- when a further investigation should be carried out and
- a broad indication of who should carry out the further investigation.

Who you should use for further investigations

You should ask an appropriately qualified person, although it is not possible to tell you which one. Specialists belonging to different types of organisations will be able to do this. For example, qualified electricians can belong to five different government-approved schemes. If you want further advice, please contact the surveyor.



Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service and terms of engagement

Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service and terms of engagement

The service

The RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service includes:

- a physical **inspection** of the property (see *The inspection* below) and
- a **report** based on the inspection (see *The report* below).

The surveyor who provides the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service aims to give you professional advice to help you to:

- make an informed decision on whether to go ahead with buying the property
- take into account any repairs or replacements the property needs, and
- consider what further advice you should take before committing to purchasing the property.

Any extra services provided that are not covered by the terms and conditions of this service must be covered by a separate contract.

The inspection

The surveyor inspects the inside and outside of the main building and all permanent outbuildings, recording the construction and significant visible defects that are evident. This inspection is intended to cover as much of the property as is physically accessible. Where this is not possible, an explanation is provided in the 'Limitations on the inspection' box in the relevant section of the report.

The surveyor does not force or open up the fabric of the building. This includes taking up fitted carpets, fitted floor coverings or floorboards; moving heavy furniture; removing the contents of cupboards, roof spaces, etc.; removing secured panels and/or hatches; or undoing electrical fittings.

If necessary, the surveyor carries out parts of the inspection when standing at ground level, from adjoining public property where accessible. This means the extent of the inspection will depend on a range of individual circumstances at the time of inspection, and the surveyor judges each case on an individual basis.

The surveyor uses equipment such as a damp meter, binoculars and torch, and uses a ladder for flat roofs and for hatches no more than 3m above level ground (outside) or floor surfaces (inside) if it is safe to do so.

If it is safe and reasonable to do so, the surveyor will enter the roof space and visually inspect the roof structure with attention paid to those parts vulnerable to deterioration and damage. Although the surveyor does not move or lift insulation material, stored goods or other contents.

The surveyor also carries out a desk-top study and makes oral enquiries for information about matters affecting the property.

Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service and terms of engagement

Services to the property

Services are generally hidden within the construction of the property. This means that only the visible parts of the available services can be inspected, and the surveyor does not carry out specialist tests. The visual inspection cannot assess the efficiency or safety of electrical, gas or other energy sources; plumbing, heating or drainage installations (or whether they meet current regulations); or the inside condition of any chimney, boiler or other flue.

Outside the property

The surveyor inspects the condition of boundary walls, fences, permanent outbuildings and areas in common (shared) use. To inspect these areas, the surveyor walks around the grounds and any neighbouring public property where access can be obtained. Where there are restrictions to access (e.g. a creeper plant prevents closer inspection), these are reported and advice is given on any potential underlying risks that may require further investigation.

Buildings with swimming pools and sports facilities are also treated as permanent outbuildings and are therefore inspected, but the surveyor does not report on the leisure facilities, such as the pool itself and its equipment internally or externally, landscaping and other facilities (for example, tennis courts and temporary outbuildings).

Flats

When inspecting flats, the surveyor assesses the general condition of the outside surfaces of the building, as well as its access areas (for example, shared hallways and staircases that lead directly to the subject flat) and roof spaces, but only if they are accessible from within and owned by the subject flat. The surveyor does not inspect drains, lifts, fire alarms and security systems.

External wall systems are not inspected. If the surveyor has specific concerns about these items, further investigation will be recommended before making a legal commitment to purchase.

Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service and terms of engagement

Dangerous materials, contamination and environmental issues

The surveyor does not make any enquiries about contamination or other environmental dangers. However, if the surveyor suspects a problem, they should recommend further investigation.

The surveyor may assume that no harmful or dangerous materials have been used in the construction, and does not have a duty to justify making this assumption. However, if the inspection shows that such materials have been used, the surveyor must report this and ask for further instructions.

The surveyor does not carry out an asbestos inspection and does not act as an asbestos inspector when inspecting properties that may fall within The Control of Asbestos Regulations 2012 ('CAR 2012'). However, the report should properly emphasise the suspected presence of asbestos containing materials if the inspection identifies that possibility. With flats, the surveyor assumes that there is a 'dutyholder' (as defined in CAR 2012), and that there is an asbestos register and an effective management plan in place, which does not present a significant risk to health or need any immediate payment. The surveyor does not consult the dutyholder.

The report

The surveyor produces a report of the inspection results for you to use, but cannot accept any liability if it is used by anyone else. If you decide not to act on the advice in the report, you do this at your own risk. The report objectively describes the condition of the elements and provides an assessment of the relative importance of the defects/problems. Although it is concise, the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) report does include advice about repairs or any ongoing maintenance issues. Where the surveyor is unable to reach a conclusion with reasonable confidence, a recommendation for further investigation should be made.

Condition ratings

The surveyor gives condition ratings to the main parts (the 'elements') of the main building, garage and some outside elements. The condition ratings are described as follows:

- **Condition rating 3** – Defects that are serious and/or need to be repaired, replaced or investigated urgently. Failure to do so could risk serious safety issues or severe long-term damage to your property.
- **Condition rating 2** – Defects that need repairing or replacing, but are not considered to be either serious or urgent. The property must be maintained in the normal way
- **Condition rating 1** – No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.
- **NI** – Elements not inspected.

The surveyor notes in the report if it was not possible to check any parts of the property that the inspection would normally cover. If the surveyor is concerned about these parts, the report tells you about any further investigations that are needed.

Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service and terms of engagement

Energy

The surveyor has not prepared the Energy Performance Certificate (EPC) as part of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service for the property. Where the EPC has not been made available by others, the most recent certificate will be obtained from the appropriate central registry where practicable. If the surveyor has seen the current EPC, they will review and state the relevant energy efficiency and rating in this report. In addition, as part of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service, checks are made for any obvious discrepancies between the EPC and the subject property, and the implications are explained to you.

Issues for legal advisors

The surveyor does not act as a legal adviser and does not comment on any legal documents. If, during the inspection, the surveyor identifies issues that your legal advisers may need to investigate further, the surveyor may refer to these in the report (for example, to state you should check whether there is a warranty covering replacement windows).

This report has been prepared by a surveyor merely in their capacity as an employee or agent of a firm, company or other business entity ('the Company'). The report is the product of the Company, not of the individual surveyor. All of the statements and opinions contained in this report are expressed entirely on behalf of the Company, which accepts sole responsibility for them. For their part, the individual surveyor assumes no personal financial responsibility or liability in respect of the report, and no reliance or inference to the contrary should be drawn.

In the case of sole practitioners, the surveyor may sign the report in their own name, unless the surveyor operates as a sole trader limited liability company.

Nothing in this report excludes or limits liability for death or personal injury (including disease and impairment of mental condition) resulting from negligence.

Risks

This section summarises defects and issues that present a risk to the building or grounds, or a safety risk to people. These may have been reported and condition rated against more than one part of the property, or may be of a more general nature. They may have existed for some time and cannot be reasonably changed. If the property is leasehold, the surveyor gives you general advice and details of questions you should ask your legal advisers. The RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) report will identify and list the risks, and explain the nature of these problems.

Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service and terms of engagement

Standard terms of engagement

1 The service – The surveyor provides the standard RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service described in this section, unless you agree with the surveyor in writing before the inspection that the surveyor will provide extra services. Any extra service will require separate terms of engagement to be entered into with the surveyor. Examples of extra services include:

- costing of repairs
- schedules of works
- supervision of works
- re-inspection
- detailed specific issue reports and
- market valuation and reinstatement costs.

2 The surveyor – The service will be provided by an AssocRICS, MRICS or FRICS member of the Royal Institution of Chartered Surveyors (RICS) who has the skills, knowledge and experience to survey and report on the property.

3 Before the inspection – Before the inspection, you should tell us if there is already an agreed or proposed price for the property, and if you have any particular concerns about the property (such as a crack noted above the bathroom window or any plans for extension).

4 Terms of payment – You agree to pay the surveyor's fee and any other charges agreed in writing.

5 Cancelling this contract – You should seek advice on your obligations under The Consumer Contracts (Information, Cancellation and Additional Charges) Regulations 2013 ('the Regulations') and/or the Consumer Rights Act 2015, in accordance with section 2.6 of the current edition of the Home survey standard RICS professional statement.

6 Liability – The report is provided for your use, and the surveyor cannot accept responsibility if it is used, or relied upon, by anyone else.

Note: These terms form part of the contract between you and the surveyor.

This report is for use in the UK.

Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 2 (survey only) service and terms of engagement

Complaints handling procedure

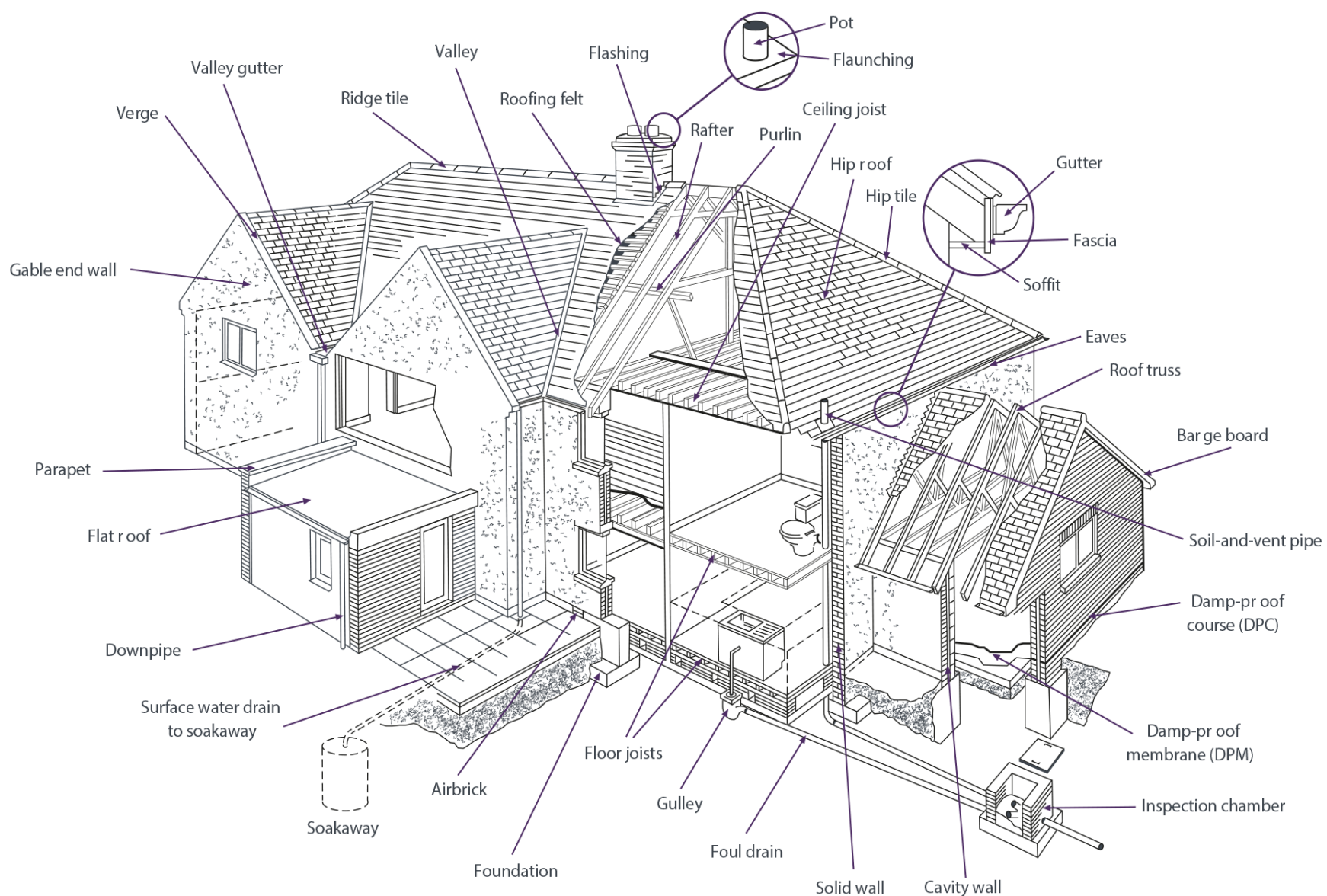
The surveyor will have a complaints handling procedure and will give you a copy if you ask for it. The surveyor is required to provide you with contact details, in writing, for their complaints department or the person responsible for dealing with client complaints. Where the surveyor is party to a redress scheme, those details should also be provided. If any of this information is not provided, please notify the surveyor and ask for it to be supplied.

M

Typical house diagram

Typical house diagram

This diagram illustrates where you may find some of the building elements referred to in the report.



RICS disclaimer

You should know...

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Maintenance tips

Your home needs maintaining in the normal way, and this general advice may be useful when read together with your report. It is not specific to this property and does not include comprehensive details. Problems in construction may develop slowly over time. If you are concerned contact an RICS qualified surveyor for further advice.

Outside the property

You should check the condition of your property at least once a year and after unusual storms.

Routine redecoration of the outside of the property will also give you an opportunity to closely examine the building.

- Chimney stacks: Check these occasionally for signs of cracked cement, split or broken pots, or loose and gaping joints in the brickwork or render. Storms may loosen aerials or other fixings, including the materials used to form the joints with the roof coverings
- Roof coverings: Check these occasionally for slipped, broken and missing tiles or slates, particularly after storms.

Flat roofing has a limited life, and is at risk of cracking and blistering. You should not walk on a flat roof. Where possible keep it free from debris. If it is covered with spar chippings, make sure the coverage is even, and replace chippings where necessary.

- Rainwater pipes and gutters: Clear any debris at least once a year, and check for leaks when it is raining. You should also check for any loose downpipe connectors and broken fixings.
- Main walls: Check main walls for cracks and any uneven bulging. Maintain the joints in brickwork and repair loose or broken rendering. Re-paint decorated walls regularly. Cut back or remove plants that are harmful to mortar and render. Keep the soil level well below the level of any damp proof course (150mm minimum recommended) and make sure any ventilation bricks are kept clear. Check over cladding for broken, rotted or damaged areas that need repairing.
- Windows and doors: Once a year check all frames for signs of rot in wood frames, for any splits in plastic or metal frames and for rusting to latches and hinges in metal frames. Maintain all decorated frames by repairing or redecorating at the first sign of any deterioration. In autumn check double glazing for condensation between the glazing, as this is a sign of a faulty unit. Have broken or cracked glass replaced by a qualified specialist. Check for broken sash cords on sliding sash windows, and sills and window boards for any damage.
- Conservatories and porches: Keep all glass surfaces clean, and clear all rainwater gutters and down pipes. Look for broken glazing and for any leaks when it's raining. Arrange for repairs by a qualified specialist.
- Other woodwork and finishes: Regularly redecorate all joinery, and check for rot and decay which you should repair at the same time.

Inside the property

You can check the inside of your property regularly when cleaning, decorating and replacing carpets or floor coverings. You should also check the roof area occasionally.

- **Roof structure:** When you access the roof area, check for signs of any leaks and the presence of vermin, rot or decay to timbers. Also look for tears to the under-felting of the roof, and check pipes, lagging and insulated areas.
- **Ceilings:** If you have a leak in the roof the first sign is often damp on the ceiling beneath the roof. Be aware if your ceiling begins to look uneven as this may indicate a serious problem, particularly for older ceilings.
- **Walls and partitions:** Look for cracking and impact damage, or damp areas which may be caused by plumbing faults or defects on the outside of the property.
- **Floors:** Be alert for signs of unevenness when you are moving furniture, particularly with timber floors
- **Fireplaces, chimney breasts and flues:** You should arrange for a qualified specialist to regularly sweep all used open chimneys. Also, make sure that bricked-up flues are ventilated. Flues to gas appliances should be checked annually by a qualified gas technician.
- **Built-in fittings:** Check for broken fittings.

Services

- Ensure all meters and control valves are easy to access and not hidden or covered over.
- Arrange for an appropriately qualified technician to check and test all gas and oil services, boilers, heating systems and connected devices ones a year
- Electrical installations should only be replaced or modified by a suitably qualified electrician and tested as specified by the Electrical Safety Council (recommended minimum of a ten year period if no alterations or additions are made, or on change of occupancy).
- Monitor plumbing regularly during use. Look out for leakage and breakages, and check insulation is adequate particularly as winter approaches.
- Lift drain covers annually to check for blockages and clean these as necessary. Check any private drainage systems annually, and arrange for a qualified contractor to clear there as necessary. Keep gullies free from debris

Grounds

- **Garages and outbuildings:** Follow the maintenance advice given for the main building.
- **Other:** Regularly prune trees, shrubs and hedges as necessary. Look out for any overhanging and unsafe branches, loose walls, fences and ornaments, particularly after storms. Clear leaves and other debris, moss and algae growth. Make sure all hard surfaces are stable and level, and not slippery or a trip hazard.



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